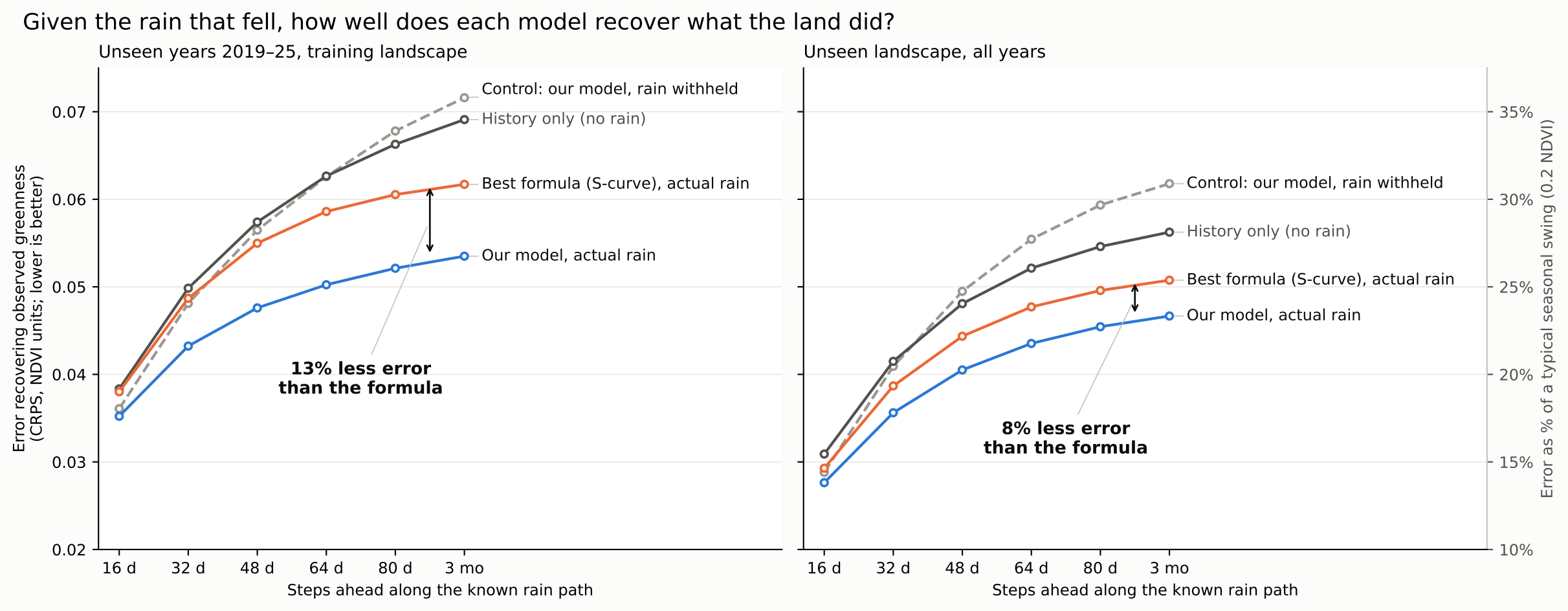
Given the rain that fell, how well does each model recover what the land did?
Unseen years 2019–25, training landscape
Unseen landscape, all years
Error recovering observed greenness
(CRPS, NDVI units; lower is better)
Error as % of a typical seasonal swing (0.2 NDVI)
0.07
0.06
0.05
0.04
0.03
0.02
35%
30%
25%
20%
15%
10%
Control: our model, rain withheld
History only (no rain)
Best formula (S-curve), actual rain
Our model, actual rain
13% less error
than the formula
8% less error
than the formula
16 d
32 d
48 d
64 d
80 d
3 mo
Steps ahead along the known rain path